Newborough Warren Weather & Water Watch: October 2026

Weather Summary

Metric	Local Gauge (IBODOR4)	Local Gauge (IHOLYH29)	RAF Valley	Typical October*
Total Rainfall	87.4 mm	115.1 mm	101.8 mm	~101.6 mm
Average Highs			15.1 C	14.3 C
Average Lows			10.2 C	9.2 C

**Based on 1991-2020 Met Office climate averages (RAF Valley).*

October saw 101.8 mm at RAF Valley, close to the 101.6 mm average (100%). Temperatures were milder than usual with lows of 10.2 C (average 9.2 C).

At the IBODOR4 gauge, rain fell on 13 of 29 days (16 dry days under 1 mm). The wettest day was 23 October (19.1 mm). The first half of the month brought 32 mm and the second half 55 mm. The longest dry spell ran 5 days.

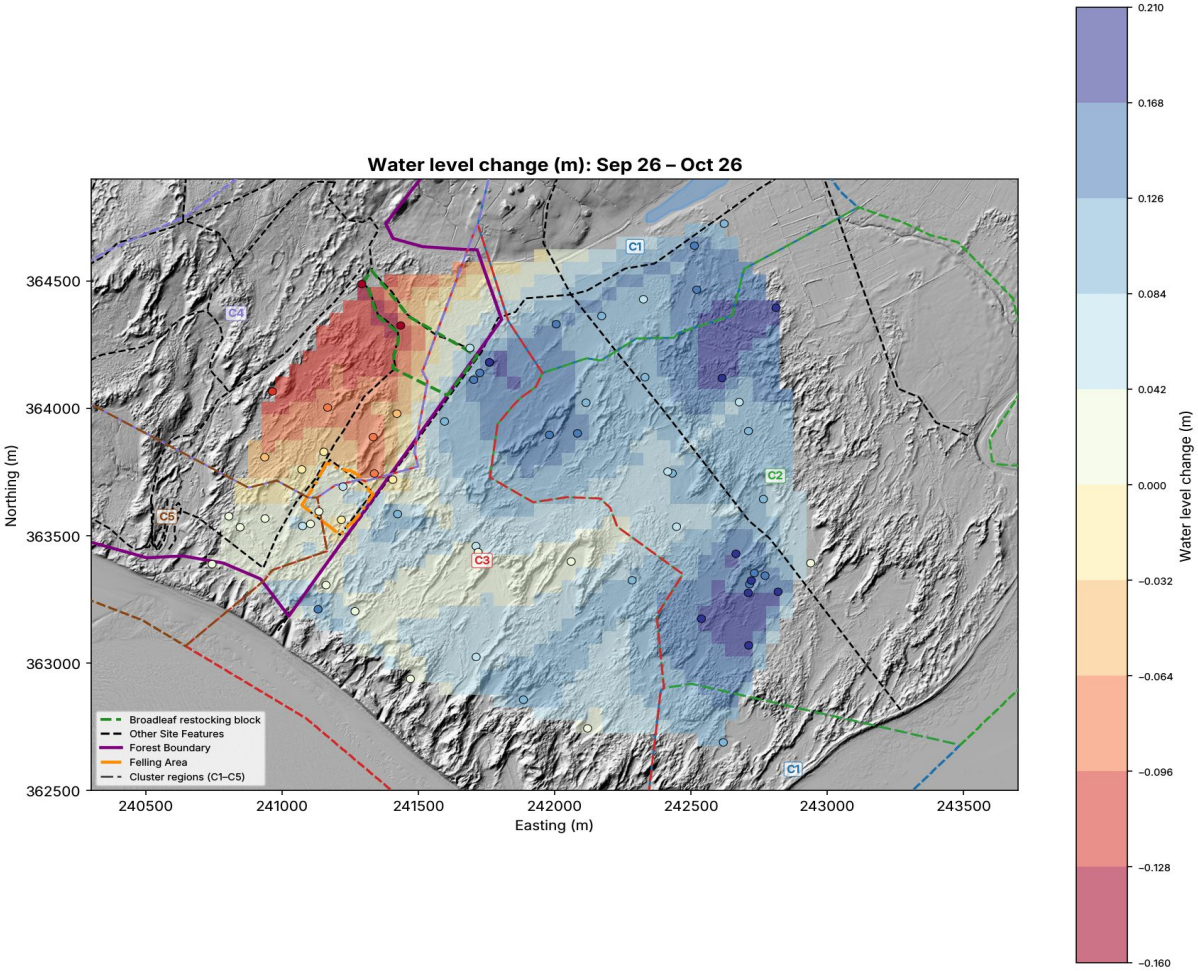
Rainfall over the twelve months to October 2026 (from November 2025) stands at 864 mm, which is 101% of the 1991–2020 average for the same twelve-month window (857 mm).

Local Water Levels

The latest well round on 03/11/2026 covered 68 monitoring dipwells across the reserve. Water levels are predominantly rising: 55 wells showed increases, 12 showed decreases, and 1 were stable. The mean change was +0.07 m.

Dry this round (4): D7 (1.06 m), ceh22 (0.94 m), nw3 (1.10 m), nw6 (0.85 m). These wells were visited and found dry, the figure being the depth below ground at which the dipper reached the bottom; they have no water level to compare, which is why they do not appear in the tables above.

Month-on-Month Change: Sep 2026 to Oct 2026

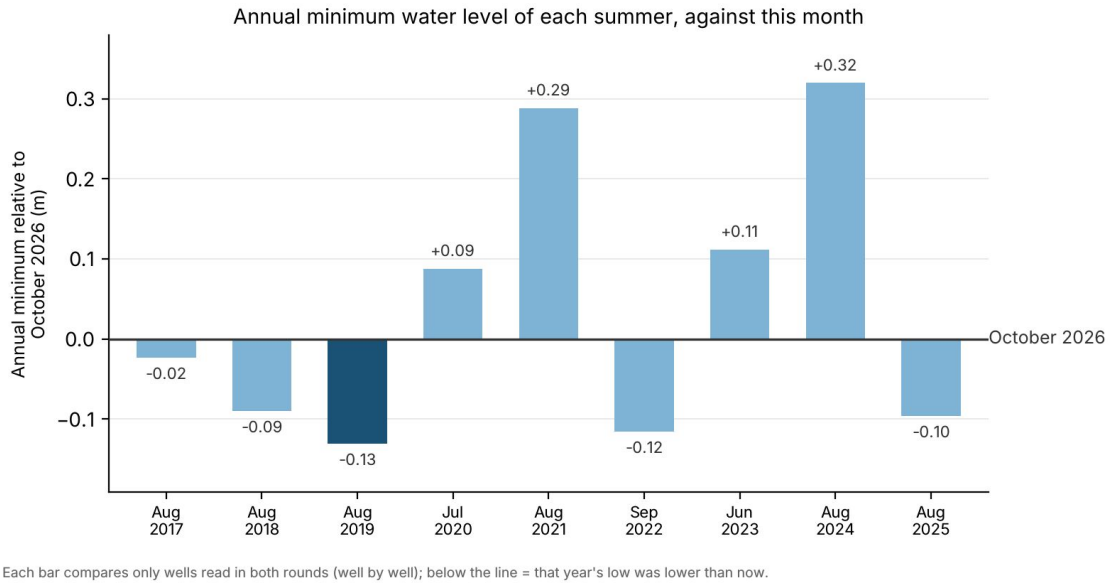


Water level change (m) from Sep 2026 to Oct 2026. Blue = rising, red = falling.

By area — C1 (Lake Edge) +0.12 m (7); C2 (Dune) +0.13 m (17); C3 (Western Residual) +0.10 m (24); C4 (Main Forest) -0.08 m (11); C5 (Coastal Forest) +0.03 m (9). C2 (Dune) rose most (+0.13 m), and C4 (Main Forest) was the only area to fall (-0.08 m); the figures in brackets are the wells compared in each. The outlines on the map are these five areas (nearest-well partitions of the cluster membership, a rendering of membership rather than a surveyed boundary).

Against the last 9 years: the deepest annual minimum of those years was August 2019. October's level is 0.13 m above it (across 62 wells read on both occasions), and lower than 4 of the 9 annual minima.

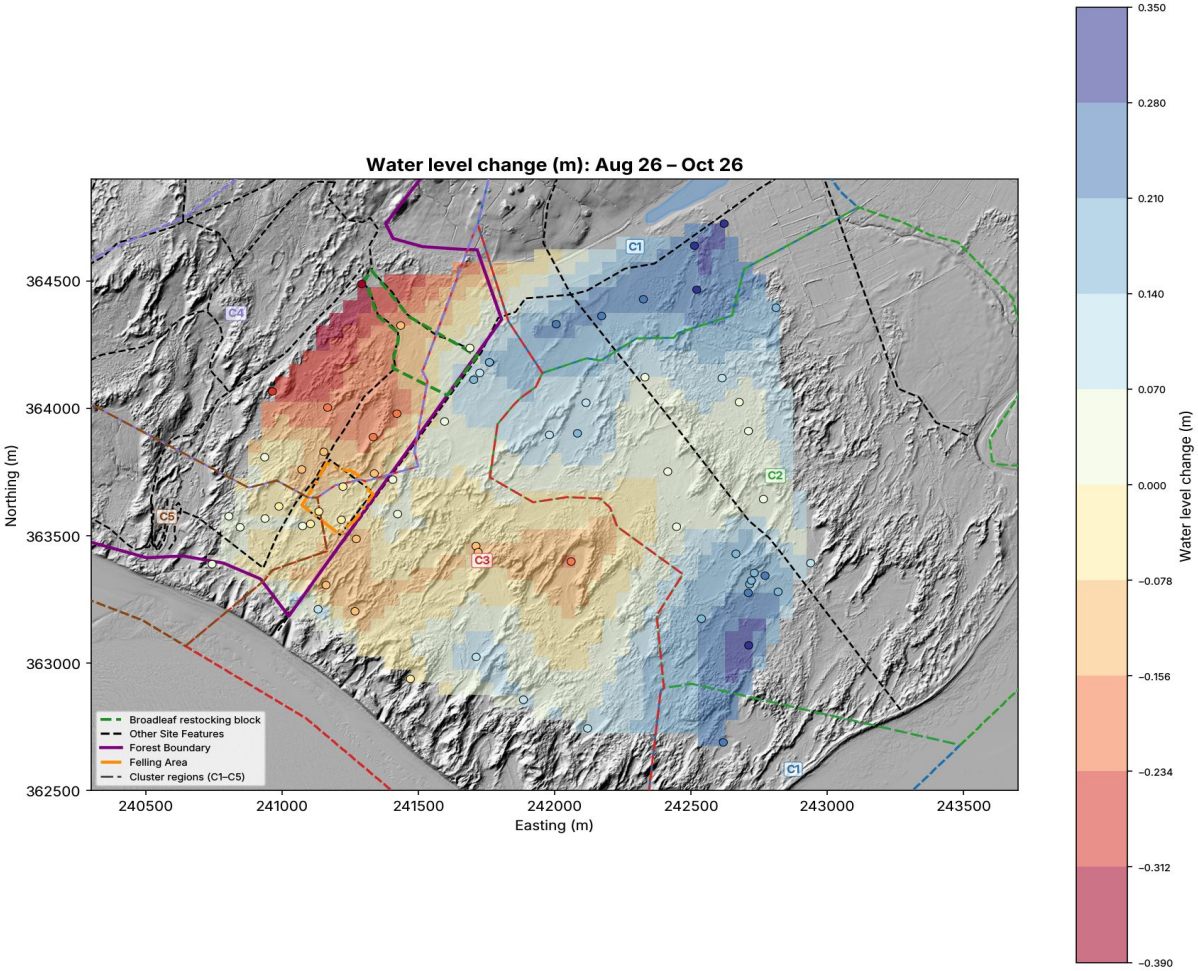
Annual Minima of Previous Years



Each summer's annual minimum relative to October 2026, compared well by well. Below the line, that year's low was lower than this month; the darker bar is the lowest of the period.

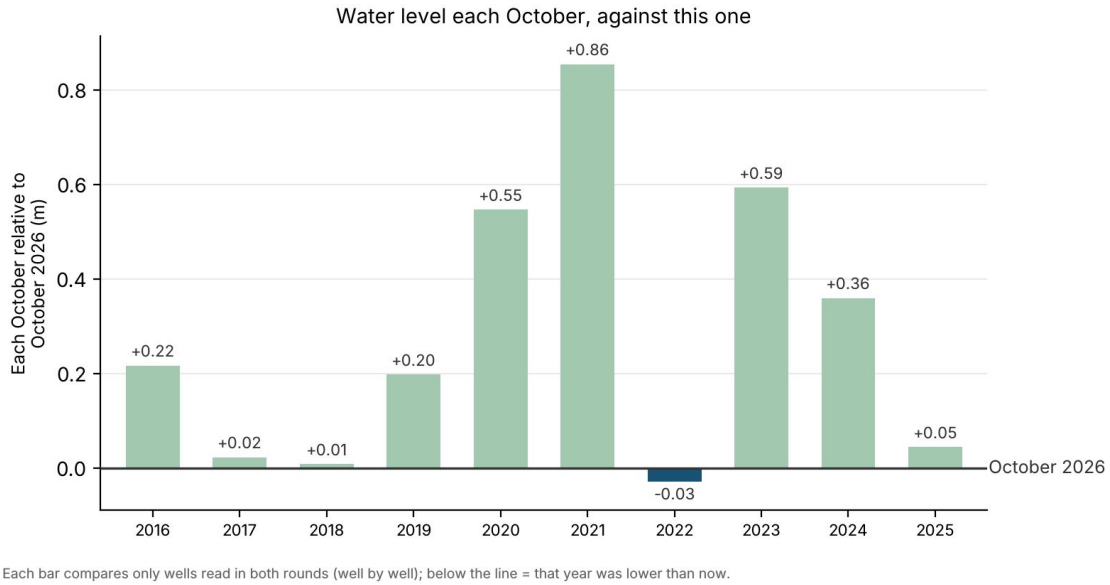
This year's lowest round was September 2026; since it the water table has risen 0.07 m across 68 wells.

Difference from the Lowest Minimum: Aug 2026 to Oct 2026



Water level change (m) from Aug 2026 to October 2026. Blue = higher now, red = lower now. August is the baseline every year, so each year's comparison runs from the same month; the lowest round of summer 2026 was in fact September 2026, 0.02 m below August.

Every October So Far



Each bar compares only wells read in both rounds (well by well); below the line = that year was lower than now.

Each earlier October relative to October 2026, compared well by well. Below the line, that year was lower than now. This October is higher than 1 of the 10 compared and lower than 9.

Flood Outlook for the Coming Winter

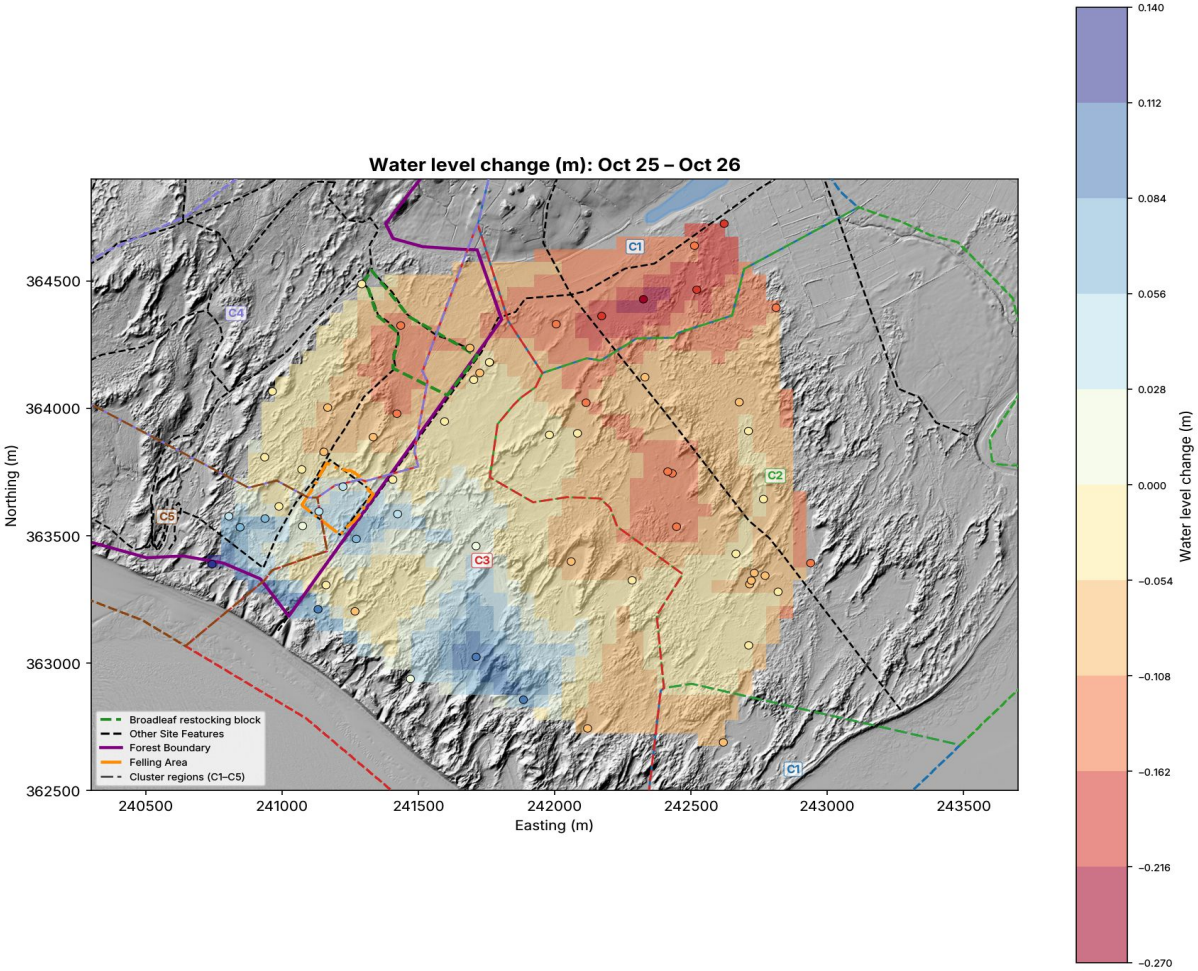
Each part of the warren has a measured rainfall threshold: the amount that would have to fall **between October 2026 and the end of January 2027** to bring the water table up to the ground surface, given how deep it fell this summer. The window ends when that area's water table peaks, which is why it differs between areas. **C1 (Lake Edge) is closest**, needing 495 mm by the end of January 2027 against a typical 400 mm — about 124% of an average season. So far 102 mm has fallen, with 1 of those 4 months elapsed.

Area	Summer low (m)	Rain needed	By	Typical	Needed / typical
C1 (Lake Edge)	1.05	495 mm	end Jan 2027	400 mm	1.24
C2 (Dune)	1.17	597 mm	end Feb 2027	461 mm	1.30
C3 (Western Residual)	1.31	657 mm	end Feb 2027	461 mm	1.43
C4 (Main Forest)	1.79	955 mm	end Feb 2027	461 mm	2.07
C5 (Coastal Forest)	1.75	1037 mm	end Feb 2027	461 mm	2.25

A ratio above 1 means a wetter-than-average season would be needed for the water table to reach the surface there; below 1, an average season would do it. The 'typical' figure is the climatological total for that same window, so the two are like for like. These are rainfall thresholds, not probabilities.

Year-on-Year Comparison: Oct 2025 vs Oct 2026

Compared to this time last year, 13 out of 67 wells are showing higher water levels, with a mean change of -0.05 m (range -0.25 to +0.12 m).



Year-on-year water level change from Oct 2025 to Oct 2026.

By area — C1 (Lake Edge) -0.17 m (7); C2 (Dune) -0.08 m (17); C3 (Western Residual) -0.01 m (22); C4 (Main Forest) -0.05 m (11); C5 (Coastal Forest) +0.05 m (10). C5 (Coastal Forest) rose most (+0.05 m) while 4 areas fell, C1 (Lake Edge) furthest (-0.17 m); the figures in brackets are the wells compared in each. The outlines on the map are these five areas (nearest-well partitions of the cluster membership, a rendering of membership rather than a surveyed boundary).

Well Measurement Summary

Largest Risers and Fallers (month-on-month)

Well	Change (m)
wmc4	+0.19
D10	+0.19
T41a	+0.19
nw13	+0.18
ceh10	+0.18

Well	Change (m)
ceh34	-0.08
FE1	-0.09
ceh13	-0.12
ceh14	-0.13
nw10	-0.14

Full data: 68 wells. Mean: +0.07 m. Range: -0.14 to +0.19 m.